

# Viewership and Ratings Trends of The Simpsons 1989 - 2023

| Introduction | Total Views per Season | Seasons with Most Viewers | IMDb Rating per Season | Relationship Between Views and Ratings | Highest Rated Episodes | Lowest Rated Episodes |
|--------------|------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
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In this project, I analyzed viewership numbers and ratings of television program *The Simpsons* to explore a widely held belief: that the show experienced a significant decline in quality over time. My goal was to determine if the data supports this perspective and to pinpoint when this decline may have begun. My dataset covers every episode of *The Simpsons* from its start in 1989 to 2023.

Link to Dataset : <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/johnbown/simpsons-episodes-2016/data?select=simps..>



## Questions to Answer:

Does the data support the opinion that there has been a drop in quality of the program?

If so, when does this decline occur?

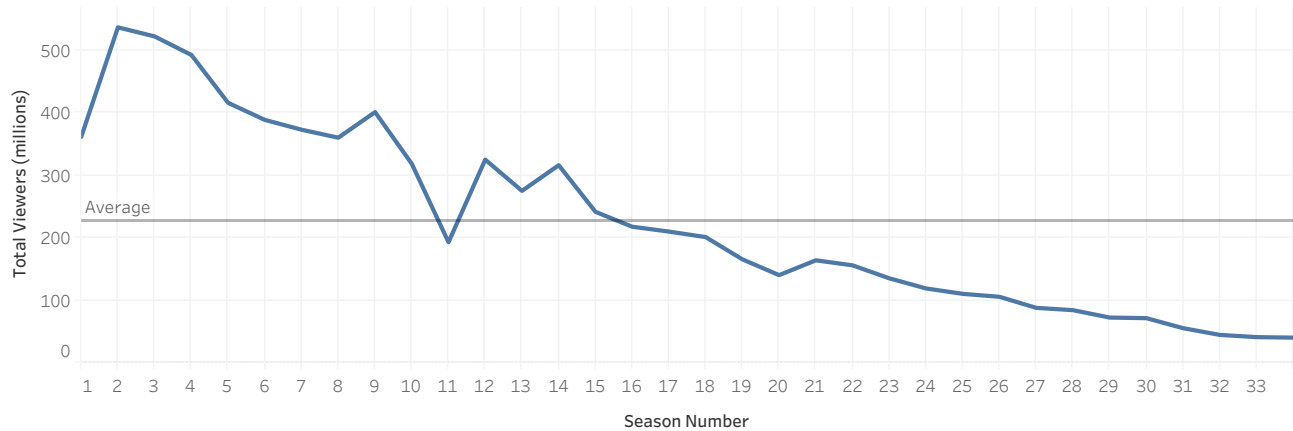
Are there episodes from the newer seasons that match the quality of the show during its heyday?

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This graph demonstrates trends in total viewership numbers for each season of *The Simpsons*, highlighting how audience numbers have changed over time

Total Views per Season



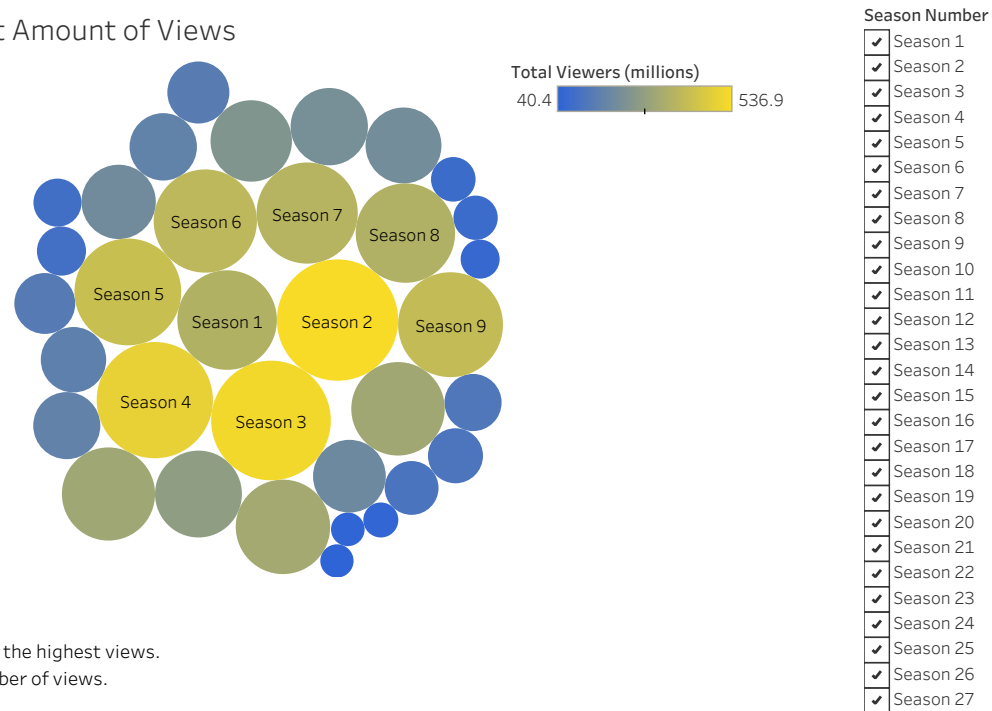
- Key Insights**
- Viewership is at its highest during the first four seasons.
  - Season 2 had highest number of viewers out of every season.
  - The average viewers across all seasons is 227.8 million.
  - Season 16 drops below average and constantly trends downward in viewership.

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This is another look into viewership numbers by season. The larger and vibrant yellow seasons had the highest number of total views.

## Seasons with the Highest Amount of Views



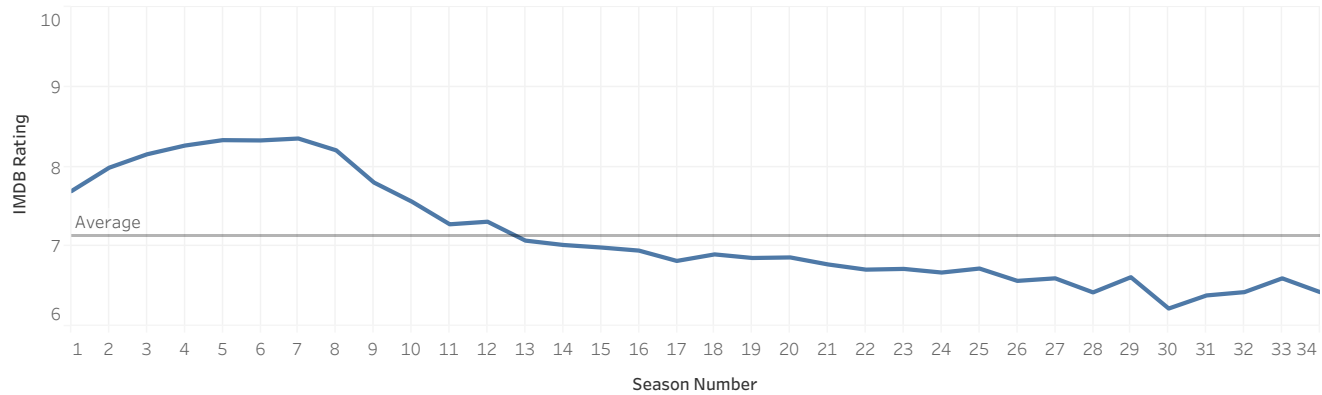
- Key insights:**
- Seasons 1 through 10 constantly had the highest views.
  - Current seasons have the lowest number of views.

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This line graph visualizes ratings overtime, by measuring the average IMDB rating per season

Average IMDb Rating by Season

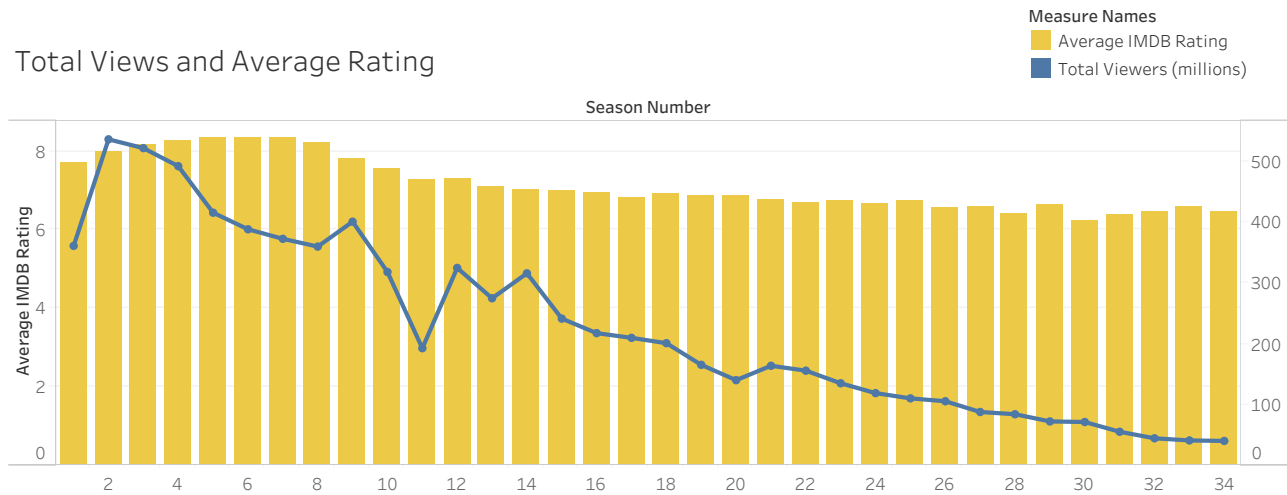


- Key Insights:**
- Average IMDB across all seasons is 7.135
  - Season 8 begins overall decline in ratings
  - Beginning with Season 13, the average rating falls below the show’s overall average and never fully recovers
  - Season 7 has the highest rating with a 8.352 rating
  - Season 30 has lowest rating with a 6.222 rating

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|                        |                           |                        |                                        |                        |                       |                              |
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This chart illustrates the relationship between total viewership numbers and average IMDb ratings by season.



- Key Insights:**
- Viewership trends do not always align with ratings.
  - Seasons 3–7 show an increase in ratings despite a decrease in viewership.
  - Beginning with season 10, viewership and ratings decline in tandem. This suggests that lower ratings may contribute to declining viewership as audience satisfaction diminishes.

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| Seasons with Most Viewers | IMDb Rating per Season | Relationship Between Views and Ratings | Highest Rated Episodes | Lowest Rated Episodes | Above Average Rated Episodes | Summary |
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|                           |                        |                                        |                        |                       |                              |         |

This treemap highlights the 25 highest-rated episodes of *The Simpsons* based on IMDB scores. Dark blue squares represent episodes with the highest scores, while vibrant yellow indicates episodes with comparatively lower scores within the top 25. The accompanying graph shows the years these standout episodes aired, offering insight into when the show’s most highly rated episodes were released.

Highest Rated Episodes of *The Simpsons* by IMDb Score



|                                   |                                                  |                                                |                                           |                                         |                                    |                                        |                     |                                                        |                             |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Homer's Enemy<br>1997<br>Season 8 | Who Shot Mr. Burns? - Part I<br>1995<br>Season 6 | Homer the Great<br>1995<br>Season 6            | The Springfield Files<br>1997<br>Season 8 | Homer the Heretic<br>1992<br>Season 4   | Flaming Moe's<br>1991<br>Season 3  | Homer the Smithers<br>1996<br>Season 7 |                     | Homer vs. the Eighteenth Amendment<br>1997<br>Season 8 |                             |
|                                   |                                                  | King-Size Homer<br>1995<br>Season 7            | Who Shot Mr. Burns? - Part II<br>1995     | And Maggie Makes Three<br>1995          |                                    |                                        |                     |                                                        |                             |
| Cape Feare<br>1993<br>Season 5    | You Only Move Twice<br>1996<br>Season 8          | Last Exit to Springfield<br>1993<br>Season 4   | 22 Short Films About Springfield<br>1996  | Bart Sells His Soul<br>1995<br>Season 7 | Homer's Phobia<br>1997<br>Season 8 |                                        | One Fish, Two Fish, |                                                        | Rosebud<br>1993<br>Season 5 |
|                                   |                                                  | The City of New York vs. Homer Simpson<br>1997 |                                           | Homer Badman<br>1994<br>Season 6        |                                    |                                        |                     |                                                        |                             |

Years with Top-Rated Episodes

| Year of Original Air Date | Count of Top Rated Episodes |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1991                      | 2                           |
| 1992                      | 2                           |
| 1993                      | 4                           |

- Key Insights :
- Highest rated episode of all time: "*Homer’s Enemy*" from season 8 (1997).
  - Seasons 2 through 8 have all top 25 episodes (1991 - 1997).
  - Of the 25 epsiodes, 5 of them aired in season 6.

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|                           |                        |                                        |                        |                       |                              |         |

Like the previous graph, this treemap showcases the 25 lowest-rated episodes of *The Simpsons* based on IMDb scores. Larger, dark blue squares represent episodes with relatively higher ratings within this group, while smaller, vibrant yellow squares indicate the lowest-rated episodes. The accompanying graph displays the years these episodes aired, offering insight into when the show's weakest-rated episodes occurred.

Lowest Rated Episodes of *The Simpsons* by IMDb score

Average IMDb Rating  
4.000 5.900

|                                                       |                                                      |                                                     |                                                    |                                                        |                                                  |                                                       |                                    |                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Do Pizza Bots<br>Dream of Electric<br>Guitars<br>2021 | I Want You (She's<br>So Heavy)<br>2019<br>Season 30  | Pixelated and<br>Afraid<br>2022<br>Season 33        | What to Expect<br>When Bart's<br>Expecting<br>2014 | Every Man's<br>Dream<br>2015<br>Season 27              | I'm Just a Girl<br>Who Can't Say<br>D'oh<br>2019 | The Musk<br>Who Fell to<br>Earth<br>2015<br>Season 26 | Gump<br>Roast<br>2002<br>Season 13 | Fan-ily<br>Feud<br>2023<br>Season 34 |
| Another Simpsons<br>Clip Show<br>1994<br>Season 6     | Moe Goes from<br>Rags to Riches<br>2012<br>Season 23 | The Hateful<br>Eight-Year-Olds<br>2020<br>Season 31 | Write Off This<br>Episode<br>2023<br>Season 34     | The 7 Beer Itch<br>2020<br>Season 32                   | Marge the<br>Lumberjill<br>2019<br>Season 31     | All Singing, All<br>Dancing<br>1998                   | The<br>Star of<br>the              | Lisa<br>Goes<br>Gaga<br>2012         |
| D'oh Canada<br>2019<br>Season 30                      | Now Museum,<br>Now You Don't<br>2020<br>Season 32    | Werking Mom<br>2018<br>Season 30                    | Clown in the<br>Dumps<br>2014<br>Season 26         | The Greatest<br>Story Ever D'ohed<br>2010<br>Season 21 | Yokel Hero<br>2021<br>Season 32                  | Bart vs. Itchy &<br>Scratchy<br>2019                  |                                    |                                      |

## Years with Low-Rated Episodes

| Year of Original Air Date | Count of Low Rated Episodes |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1994                      | 1                           |
| 1998                      | 1                           |
| 2002                      | 1                           |
| 2010                      | 1                           |

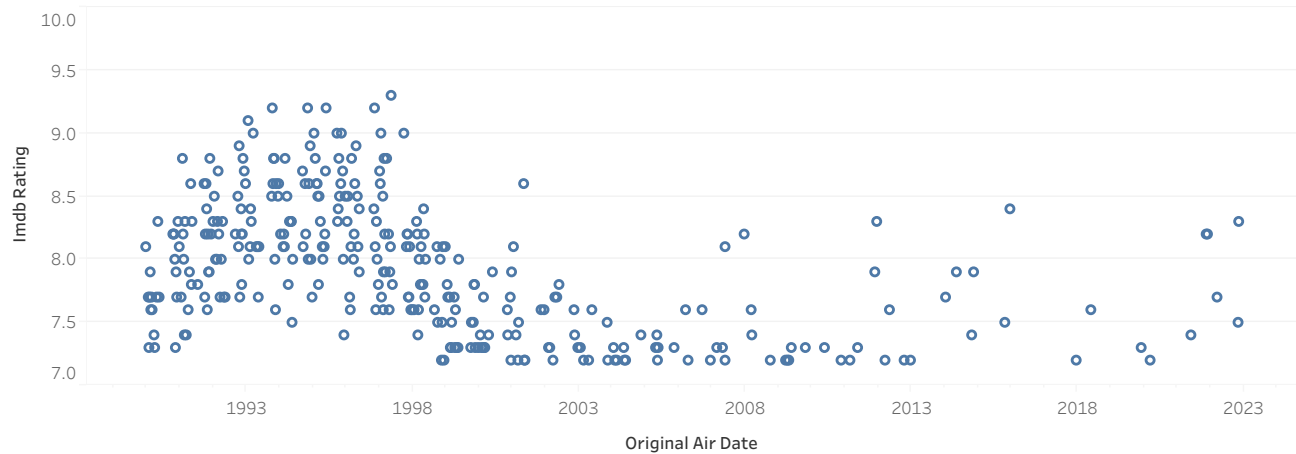
- Key Insights:**
- The majority of the lowest-rated episodes are from recent years, with nearly 70% airing in the past decade.
  - Lowest rated episode of all time: "*Lisa Goes Gaga*" from season 23 (2012)
  - "*Another Simpsons Clip Show*", "*Gump Roast*", and "*Fan-ily Feud*" are all clip shows - compiliations of scenes from previously aired episodes.

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I aimed to create a list of episodes worth watching. This graph highlights all episodes rated above the average IMDB score of 7 out of 10, each dot represents a singular episode.

Episodes with Above Average IMDb Rating



**Key Insights:**  
- While many fans have stopped watching recent episodes, this graph demonstrates that there are plenty of newer episodes with positive reviews.

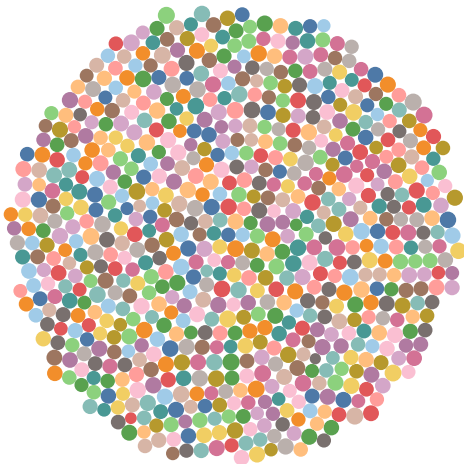
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### Summary of findings:

- The show reached its peak viewership in Season 2, and no subsequent season surpassed these numbers.
- Viewership took a noticeable decline in Season 11 but bounced back significantly in Season 12.
- The show's viewership began a consistent decline around Season 15.
- Season 7 holds the highest average IMDb rating.
- Ratings started dropping after Season 8 and fell below average by Season 13.
- Most of the top-rated episodes come from the earliest seasons, while the later seasons hold the bulk of the lowest-rated ones.
- Clip show episodes have consistently poor ratings.
- For fans who have stopped keeping up with the current seasons, there are still plenty of highly rated episodes worth checking out in the more recent seasons.

Here is every episode of *The Simpsons* from season 1 through 23, each dot representing a singular episode. Click a dot to see details from this episode.



| Title                      |  |
|----------------------------|--|
| 3 Scenes Plus a Tag fr..   |  |
| 22 for 30                  |  |
| 22 Short Films About ..    |  |
| 24 Minutes                 |  |
| 101 Mitigations            |  |
| 500 Keys                   |  |
| 'Round Springfield         |  |
| 'Scuse Me While I Mis..    |  |
| 'Tis the 30th Season       |  |
| 'Tis the Fifteenth Sea..   |  |
| \$pringfield (or, How I .. |  |
| A Father's Watch           |  |
| A Fish Called Selma        |  |
| A Hunka Hunka Burns..      |  |
| A Made Maggie              |  |
| A Midsummer's Nice ..      |  |
| A Milhouse Divided         |  |
| A Serious Flanders" (.     |  |
| A Springfield Summe..      |  |
| A Star Is Born Again       |  |
| A Star Is Burns            |  |
| A Star Is Torn             |  |
| A Streetcar Named M..      |  |
| A Tale of Two Springf..    |  |
| A Test Before Trying       |  |
| A Totally Fun Thing T..    |  |
| A Tree Grows in Sprin..    |  |
| Adventures in Baby-G..     |  |